

Career Organization Types



NAME _____

DATE _____

PERIOD _____

Four types

TYPE	MAIN JOB	EXAMPLE IN THIS PACKET
CTSO	School-connected student leadership and career development	SkillsUSA, TSA
Professional association	Membership, learning, connection, and advocacy in a profession	NSPE, AOPA
Credentialing organization	Assesses or certifies knowledge and experience	ASE
Government agency	Public rules, oversight, certificates, and government work	FAA

Why two organizations can work together without becoming the same type:

Card 1: SkillsUSA — CTSO

- National nonprofit student organization serving CTE students and teachers.
- A student asks a CTE teacher or counselor whether the school has a chapter; starting a chapter requires school support.
- Current student resources include leadership, career-ready skills, work-based learning, recognition, scholarships, and career competitions.
- This card does not prove that a specific Irving campus has a chapter or that every activity is free.

Source: SkillsUSA official pages, accessed August 2026.

Type and access route:

One verified benefit and one unconfirmed local question:

Card 2: TSA — CTSO

- National nonprofit CTSO for middle- and high-school students engaged in STEM.
- Participation runs through chapters and school advisors.
- Programs include STEM competitions, leadership, and career development.
- This card does not prove a specific campus chapter, event, fee, or student eligibility.

Source: TSA 2025-26 Facts, accessed August 2026.

Type, benefit, and local access question:

Card 3: ASE — credentialing organization

- Independent nonprofit created by the automotive industry.
- Develops assessments and credentials current and future transportation professionals.
- Professional ASE certification combines the applicable test with approved work experience or substitution; Entry-Level is a separate context.
- ASE is not a school club and this card does not prove every automotive job requires one exact credential.

Source: ASE About and Work Experience pages, accessed August 2026.

Type, main function, and one claim not supported:

Card 4: FAA — federal government agency

- Part of the U.S. Department of Transportation.
- Its mission is a safe and efficient aerospace system.
- It regulates aviation, issues certificates in authorized contexts, and hires employees.
- The FAA is not a membership association or school club.

Source: FAA About, accessed August 2026.

Type, main function, and one reason “join the FAA” is inaccurate:

Card 5: NSPE — professional association

- Membership organization for professional engineers and eligible students.
- Current student eligibility is tied to qualifying college engineering, engineering technology, pre-engineering transfer, or graduate programs.
- Benefits may include professional learning, connections, advocacy, publications, events, and scholarships.
- This card does not offer blanket middle-school membership or prove a local chapter.

Source: NSPE Student Membership, accessed August 2026.

Type, one later benefit, and one eligibility boundary:

Card 6: AOPA — professional membership association

- Membership organization serving pilots and general aviation.
- Benefits vary by membership category and may include safety learning, planning tools, publications, advocacy, and expert support.
- Current eligibility and price must be checked for the specific category before joining.
- AOPA does not issue an FAA certificate.

Source: AOPA Membership, accessed August 2026.

Type, one benefit, and one verification question:

Realistic organization decision

Fictional Sam wants a school-based leadership and competition opportunity now and an aviation professional network later.

First organization to ask about now:

Card fact that supports the choice:

School access question:

Later organization to investigate:

Card fact that supports the later choice:

Eligibility or cost question:

Correct the labels

Correct: “FAA, ASE, and SkillsUSA are three professional associations I can join today.”